



Cuddles Childminders and Schools (The Cuddles Hall)

STUDENTS' CODE OF CONDUCT AND DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS

Policy Owner: Head of School
Effective Date: September 2026

Applies To: All Learners/Students
Review Cycle: Annually or as required

1.0 INTRODUCTION

Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) is committed to providing a safe, respectful, inclusive and purposeful environment in which every learner can learn, develop confidence, demonstrate responsibility and reach their potential.

The school's approach to discipline is based on the understanding that discipline is primarily **corrective, educational and restorative**, rather than punitive.

Learners are expected to understand that their choices have consequences and that they are responsible for their conduct towards themselves, other learners, staff, visitors, school property and the wider school community.

This **Students' Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Actions** establishes the standards of behaviour expected of learners and provides a framework for responding to misconduct fairly, consistently and appropriately.

The Code should be read alongside other relevant policies of Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall), including its safeguarding, anti-bullying, social media and digital communications, attendance, uniform, health and safety, and technology-use policies.

2.0 PURPOSE OF THE CODE OF CONDUCT

The purposes of this Code are to:

1. promote a safe, orderly and positive learning environment;
2. establish clear expectations for learner behaviour;

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3. promote respect, responsibility, honesty and integrity;
 4. protect the dignity, safety and wellbeing of learners and staff;
 5. discourage bullying, harassment, discrimination and violence;
 6. provide fair and proportionate responses to misconduct;
 7. help learners understand the consequences of their choices;
 8. encourage learners to repair harm caused by inappropriate behaviour;
 9. support parents and the school in working together to promote positive behaviour; and
 10. provide a clear framework for disciplinary decision-making.
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3.0 GENERAL PRINCIPLES OF EXPECTED CONDUCT

Every learner at Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) is expected to:

3.1 Show Respect

Learners must treat:

- fellow learners;
- teachers;
- administrative and support staff;
- drivers and transport personnel;
- security personnel;
- visitors;
- volunteers; and
- members of the wider school community

with courtesy, dignity and respect.

Disrespectful, abusive, humiliating, threatening or discriminatory behaviour is not acceptable.

3.2 Demonstrate Responsibility

Learners are responsible for:

- their behaviour;
- their learning;
- their personal belongings;
- school property entrusted to them;
- completing assigned work;
- following reasonable instructions; and
- accepting appropriate consequences for their actions.

3.3 Demonstrate Integrity and Honesty

Learners must be truthful and act honestly in academic and social situations.

Dishonesty includes, but is not limited to:

- cheating;
- plagiarism;
- copying another learner's work;
- falsifying information;
- stealing;
- deliberately misleading staff; and
- assisting another learner to engage in dishonest conduct.

3.4 Promote Safety

Learners must behave in a manner that does not place themselves or others at unnecessary risk.

Learners must follow:

- classroom safety procedures;
- laboratory and practical activity rules;
- playground rules;
- transport rules;
- fire and emergency procedures;
- assembly instructions; and
- instructions issued by authorised members of staff.

4.0 CLASSROOM AND LEARNING ENVIRONMENT

Learners are expected to:

- arrive prepared for lessons;
- bring required books and learning materials;
- listen when teachers or other learners are speaking;
- follow reasonable instructions;
- participate appropriately in learning activities;
- complete assigned work;
- respect the learning rights of others;
- remain in authorised areas;
- avoid unnecessary disruption; and
- use school resources responsibly.

The following behaviours are unacceptable:

- persistent talking or disruption;
- deliberately preventing others from learning;
- refusing reasonable instructions;
- leaving a classroom without permission;

- deliberately distracting others;
 - misuse of learning materials;
 - deliberate damage to classroom property; and
 - disrespectful or abusive conduct towards teachers or classmates.
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5.0 PLAYGROUND, RECESS AND COMMON AREAS

Learners must:

- use playground equipment appropriately;
- play fairly and safely;
- respect personal space;
- follow the instructions of supervising staff;
- remain within designated areas;
- queue appropriately where required;
- avoid dangerous games or physical aggression; and
- report unsafe behaviour to a member of staff.

Pushing, kicking, hitting, fighting, deliberate tripping, dangerous rough play or any behaviour likely to cause injury is prohibited.

6.0 MEALTIMES AND DINING AREAS

Learners are expected to:

- practise good table manners;
- use polite language;
- respect food and eating areas;
- follow instructions from supervising staff;
- keep eating areas clean;
- dispose of waste appropriately; and
- respect other learners' food and personal space.

Food must not be deliberately thrown, wasted, taken without permission or used to intimidate or embarrass another learner.

7.0 SCHOOL UNIFORM, PERSONAL APPEARANCE AND GROOMING

Learners are expected to attend school in the prescribed school uniform or approved clothing for the relevant activity.

Learners must:

- wear clean and appropriate uniform;
- maintain good personal hygiene;
- comply with the school's grooming requirements;
- wear appropriate footwear; and
- avoid accessories or clothing that compromise safety or the school's dress standards.

Parents/guardians are expected to support the school in ensuring that learners comply with the school's uniform and grooming requirements.

8.0 ATTENDANCE AND PUNCTUALITY

Regular attendance and punctuality are essential to learning.

Learners are expected to:

- attend school regularly;
- arrive on time;
- attend lessons promptly;
- remain in school during authorised hours; and
- obtain permission before leaving an assigned area.

Parents/guardians should notify the school promptly when a learner will be absent or late.

Repeated unexplained absence or lateness may result in a meeting with the learner and parent/guardian and may require an attendance improvement plan.

9.0 TECHNOLOGY AND DIGITAL CONDUCT

Technology provided or permitted by Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) must be used responsibly.

Learners must not:

- access inappropriate websites or content;
- use school devices for unauthorised purposes;
- damage or interfere with school technology;
- access another person's account;
- share passwords;
- record teachers, staff or learners without appropriate permission;
- photograph or record private school activities without authorisation;
- cyberbully or harass another person;
- impersonate another person online;

- share another person's private information; or
- use social media to threaten, humiliate, intimidate or deliberately harm another member of the school community.

All learners must comply with the school's **Social Media and Digital Communications Policy**.

10.0 BULLYING, HARASSMENT AND DISCRIMINATION

Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) does not tolerate bullying, harassment or discriminatory behaviour.

Bullying may be:

- physical;
- verbal;
- emotional;
- social;
- psychological;
- relational; or
- digital/cyberbullying.

Examples include:

- repeated name-calling;
- threats;
- intimidation;
- deliberate exclusion;
- spreading malicious rumours;
- humiliation;
- physical aggression;
- threatening messages;
- online harassment; and
- sharing embarrassing or private content about another person.

A learner who witnesses bullying is encouraged to report it to a trusted adult.

Retaliation against a learner who reports bullying or participates in an investigation is also prohibited.

11.0 PROHIBITED CONDUCT

The following behaviours are considered serious breaches of the Code of Conduct:

- fighting or deliberate physical aggression;
- bullying or harassment;
- threats or intimidation;
- possession or use of dangerous or prohibited items;
- theft;
- deliberate destruction of school property;
- serious academic dishonesty;
- deliberate misuse of technology;
- serious cyberbullying;
- leaving school premises without permission;
- deliberate acts that endanger another person;
- serious insubordination;
- impersonating a staff member or school official;
- possession, distribution or use of prohibited substances;
- sexual harassment or inappropriate sexual behaviour;
- sharing sexually explicit or inappropriate material;
- serious discriminatory or hateful conduct; and
- any conduct that presents a significant safeguarding or safety concern.

The school reserves the right to address behaviour that occurs outside school premises or outside school hours where such behaviour has a direct and significant impact on the safety, wellbeing or functioning of the school community.

12.0 CATEGORIES OF MISCONDUCT

For the purpose of consistency, misconduct is generally classified into three levels.

The classification of an incident will depend on factors including:

- the seriousness of the behaviour;
- the learner's age and developmental level;
- whether the behaviour was deliberate;
- whether anyone was harmed;
- whether the behaviour was repeated;
- the learner's previous conduct;
- whether the learner accepted responsibility; and
- any relevant circumstances surrounding the incident.

LEVEL 1 – MINOR MISCONDUCT

Minor misconduct generally involves behaviour that disrupts learning or school routines but does not cause significant harm.

Examples include:

- talking out of turn;
- minor classroom disruption;
- failure to follow a classroom routine;
- incomplete homework or classwork;
- minor misuse of school property;
- inappropriate but non-abusive language;
- minor lateness;
- queue jumping;
- minor playground misconduct;
- failure to bring required materials; and
- other low-level breaches of school expectations.

Possible responses include:

1. verbal reminder or correction;
2. private discussion with the learner;
3. behaviour reflection;
4. seating or activity adjustment;
5. temporary loss of a privilege;
6. supervised time away from an activity;
7. restorative action; and/or
8. parent/guardian communication where appropriate.

13.0 LEVEL 2 – MODERATE MISCONDUCT

Moderate misconduct includes repeated Level 1 behaviour or conduct that causes significant disruption, disrespect or distress.

Examples include:

- repeated refusal to follow reasonable instructions;
- repeated classroom disruption;
- persistent disrespectful behaviour;
- repeated inappropriate language;
- repeated teasing or name-calling;
- inappropriate use of technology;
- deliberate misuse of school property;
- dishonesty;
- minor acts of physical aggression;
- repeated bullying behaviour; and
- repeated breaches of school rules after intervention.

Possible responses include:

1. formal behaviour discussion;
2. written reflection;

3. restorative conference;
 4. parent/guardian notification;
 5. behaviour improvement plan;
 6. loss of privileges;
 7. supervised detention or equivalent corrective measure for age-appropriate learners;
 8. monitoring by a designated staff member;
 9. referral to the Head of School; and/or
 10. other appropriate disciplinary measures.
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14.0 LEVEL 3 – MAJOR MISCONDUCT

Major misconduct involves serious behaviour that causes, or has the potential to cause, significant harm, danger, disruption or distress.

Examples include:

- fighting or serious physical aggression;
- serious bullying or harassment;
- threats of violence;
- deliberate acts that endanger another person;
- serious vandalism;
- theft;
- serious academic dishonesty;
- possession of dangerous or prohibited items;
- serious cyberbullying;
- serious insubordination;
- leaving school premises without permission;
- serious discriminatory or threatening behaviour;
- possession, use or distribution of prohibited substances;
- serious safeguarding concerns; and
- repeated Level 2 misconduct despite appropriate interventions.

Possible responses include:

1. immediate removal from the situation;
2. safeguarding or safety assessment;
3. referral to the Head of School;
4. parent/guardian notification;
5. formal disciplinary meeting;
6. restorative conference where appropriate and safe;
7. behaviour improvement plan;
8. temporary restriction of school privileges;
9. internal suspension where considered appropriate;
10. suspension from school for a defined period;
11. review of continued enrolment; and/or

12. withdrawal or termination of enrolment in exceptional circumstances and in accordance with the school's procedures and applicable requirements.

The school will not use corporal punishment, humiliating punishment or any disciplinary method intended to degrade or physically harm a learner.

15.0 FACTORS CONSIDERED BEFORE DISCIPLINARY ACTION

Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) will consider the circumstances of each case.

Relevant considerations may include:

- the learner's age and developmental stage;
- the seriousness of the conduct;
- the learner's intention;
- whether the learner accepts responsibility;
- whether the learner has previously engaged in similar behaviour;
- the impact on others;
- whether the behaviour involved a safeguarding concern;
- whether the learner was responding to provocation;
- whether the learner has previously received support or intervention; and
- any other relevant circumstances.

Similar incidents should receive broadly consistent responses, but discipline will not necessarily be identical in every case.

16.0 RESTORATIVE DISCIPLINE

Where appropriate, Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) may use restorative practices to help learners understand the consequences of their actions and repair harm.

Restorative measures may include:

- guided reflection;
- apology;
- repairing or replacing damaged property;
- restorative conversation;
- mediated discussion;
- reconciliation;
- agreed behaviour goals; and
- follow-up support.

Restorative practices will not be used where doing so would compromise the safety, dignity or wellbeing of the affected person.

17.0 POSITIVE BEHAVIOUR AND RECOGNITION

Discipline at Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) is not limited to correcting inappropriate behaviour.

Positive conduct should be actively recognised.

Learners may receive:

- verbal praise;
- positive notes or messages;
- certificates;
- classroom recognition;
- leadership responsibilities;
- house or team recognition;
- special privileges;
- Student of the Week/Month recognition; and
- other age-appropriate rewards.

The school reserves the right to modify its rewards programme as necessary.

18.0 PARENTAL/GUARDIAN INVOLVEMENT

Parents/guardians are partners in supporting positive learner behaviour.

Parents/guardians are expected to:

- familiarise themselves with this Code;
- reinforce appropriate behaviour at home;
- communicate respectfully with the school;
- attend requested meetings;
- support agreed behaviour plans;
- encourage their child to accept responsibility; and
- work collaboratively with the school where behavioural concerns arise.

Parents/guardians should not confront or discipline another learner directly. Concerns involving another learner should be reported to the school.

19.0 THE PREFECT COURT / STUDENT MEDIATION PROCESS

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Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) may operate a **Prefect Court/Student Mediation Process** as a learner leadership and restorative mechanism.

The Prefect Court is intended primarily to help learners:

- understand the impact of their behaviour;
- practise responsible decision-making;
- develop conflict-resolution skills;
- listen to different perspectives;
- take appropriate responsibility; and
- restore relationships where possible.

Important Limitation

The Prefect Court is **not a substitute for formal school disciplinary authority**.

Cases involving serious misconduct, safeguarding concerns, violence, threats, dangerous items, sexual misconduct, serious bullying, serious harassment or other Level 3 matters **must be referred to the Teacher Advisor and/or Head of School**.

Prefects must never investigate or determine safeguarding matters independently.

19.1 STEP 1 – REFERRAL

A concern may be referred to the Prefect Court by:

- a learner;
- teacher;
- staff member; or
- other authorised member of the school community.

The Teacher Advisor determines whether the matter is suitable for peer mediation.

19.2 STEP 2 – PREPARATION

Where a matter is appropriate for peer mediation:

1. the participants are informed of the process;
2. the meeting is scheduled;
3. the Teacher Advisor ensures that appropriate supervision is available;
4. participants are reminded of expectations for respectful communication; and
5. parents/guardians are informed where required by the seriousness or nature of the matter.

19.3 STEP 3 – THE SESSION

The Head Prefect or designated student mediator:

1. welcomes participants;
2. explains the purpose and rules of the session;
3. gives each learner an opportunity to speak;
4. allows relevant witnesses to provide information where appropriate;
5. asks clarification questions;
6. identifies the harm or conflict involved; and
7. encourages participants to identify a fair and constructive resolution.

Participants must not:

- insult or threaten one another;
- intimidate witnesses;
- disclose confidential information unnecessarily;
- retaliate against another learner; or
- pressure another learner to accept an outcome.

19.4 STEP 4 – OUTCOME

Where appropriate, the outcome may include:

- an apology;
- agreement to change behaviour;
- restoration of damaged property;
- an agreed resolution;
- reconciliation;
- a behaviour commitment; or
- referral to a staff member for further action.

A prefect may **recommend** an outcome but must not impose a serious disciplinary sanction.

19.5 STEP 5 – REFERRAL OF SERIOUS MATTERS

If information disclosed during the session indicates a Level 3 matter or a safeguarding concern, the session must stop or be appropriately concluded, and the matter must be referred immediately to the **Teacher Advisor and/or Head of School**.

The prefect must not attempt to investigate the matter independently.

19.6 STEP 6 – RECORD KEEPING

A brief record of the matter and outcome may be maintained by the designated staff member.

Records relating to disciplinary or safeguarding matters must be treated as confidential and accessed only by authorised persons.

20.0 ROLE OF THE TEACHER ADVISOR

The Teacher Advisor is responsible for:

- supervising the Prefect Court;
 - ensuring that peer mediation is appropriate;
 - protecting learner welfare;
 - preventing unfair or biased proceedings;
 - intervening where necessary;
 - referring serious matters to school management;
 - reviewing proposed outcomes; and
 - ensuring appropriate follow-up.
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21.0 DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

Where formal disciplinary action is required, the school will generally follow these stages:

Stage 1 – Establish the Facts

The school will seek to understand what happened by speaking with relevant persons and reviewing available information.

Stage 2 – Allow the Learner to Respond

The learner will be given an age-appropriate opportunity to explain their account of the incident.

Stage 3 – Determine the Appropriate Response

The school will consider the seriousness of the conduct, the circumstances and the learner's previous behaviour.

Stage 4 – Communicate with Parents/Guardians

Where appropriate, parents/guardians will be informed of the incident and the action being taken.

Stage 5 – Implement the Outcome

The agreed or authorised disciplinary response will be implemented.

Stage 6 – Follow-Up

The school may monitor the learner's behaviour and provide additional support or intervention.

22.0 IMMEDIATE SAFETY MEASURES

Where a learner's behaviour presents an immediate risk to themselves or another person, the school may take immediate steps to protect safety before completing the full disciplinary process.

Such steps may include:

- removing the learner from the immediate situation;
- separating learners involved in a conflict;
- contacting a parent/guardian;
- seeking appropriate medical assistance;
- implementing safeguarding procedures; and
- involving appropriate external authorities where legally or operationally necessary.

Immediate safety measures are not, by themselves, a finding of guilt.

23.0 SUSPENSION AND WITHDRAWAL OF ENROLMENT

Suspension or withdrawal of enrolment will only be considered for serious or persistent misconduct and will be authorised by school management.

The decision will take into consideration:

- the seriousness of the conduct;
- risk to others;
- the learner's previous conduct;
- interventions already attempted;
- the learner's age and circumstances; and
- the school's obligations to maintain a safe learning environment.

Where suspension is imposed, the school will communicate the duration, expectations for return and any conditions for re-entry.

In exceptional circumstances, the school may determine that continued enrolment is no longer appropriate, in accordance with the school's enrolment terms and applicable requirements.

24.0 APPEALS AND REVIEW

A learner or parent/guardian who believes that a formal disciplinary decision was unfair may request a review.

Appeal Procedure

1. The appeal should be submitted in writing to the **Head of School** within **five school days** of the decision.
2. The appeal should clearly state the decision being challenged and the reason for the appeal.
3. The school may review relevant records and information.
4. The learner and parent/guardian may be invited to provide further information.
5. The Head of School or designated senior administrator will review the matter.
6. A written outcome will be communicated to the parent/guardian.

Where the Head of School made the original decision, the school may designate another appropriate senior authority to conduct the review.

The outcome of the appeal will normally be considered final within the school's internal process.

25.0 CONFIDENTIALITY AND RECORD KEEPING

Disciplinary records will be maintained securely and accessed only by authorised personnel.

Information relating to a learner's disciplinary matter should not be discussed publicly or shared with persons who do not have a legitimate reason to receive it.

Learners, parents and staff are expected to respect the privacy of everyone involved in a disciplinary process.

26.0 PROHIBITED DISCIPLINARY PRACTICES

Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) is committed to discipline that protects the dignity and wellbeing of every learner.

The following are prohibited:

- corporal punishment;
- physical assault or intentional physical harm;
- humiliating or degrading punishment;
- threats of violence;
- public shaming;
- discriminatory punishment;
- punishment involving food deprivation;
- denial of essential toilet or water access;
- forced physical exercise as punishment where unsafe or inappropriate; and
- any disciplinary action that places a learner at unreasonable risk of harm.

Discipline must be **reasonable, proportionate, age-appropriate and consistent with safeguarding requirements.**

27.0 REVIEW OF THIS POLICY

This Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Actions Policy will be reviewed periodically by the school to ensure that it remains appropriate, effective and aligned with current educational, safeguarding and child-protection expectations.

Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall) reserves the right to amend this policy where necessary.

28.0 ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The Code of Conduct forms part of the expectations for all learners enrolled at Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall).

Learners and their parents/guardians are expected to read, understand and support the standards contained in this policy.

The school, learners and parents/guardians share responsibility for creating an environment in which every learner can feel **safe, respected, supported and able to learn.**

Odomo Olubukola F. (Mrs.)
Head of School
Cuddles Childminders & Schools (The Cuddles Hall)

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